

Genesis 1:4 - Hebrew Handwriting & Reading Practice

Learn the word, say every letter name, notice what each mark does, then write it.

וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאוֹר כִּי־טוֹב וַיַּבְדֵּל אֱלֹהִים בֵּין הָאוֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ׃

Pronunciation: vai-YAR eh-lo-HEEM et ha-OR kee TOVE vai-yav-DEL eh-lo-HEEM bane ha-OR oo-VANE ha-KHO-shekh.

Meaning: And God saw the light, that it was good; and God divided the light from the darkness.

Word order

#	Hebrew	Transliteration	Pronunciation	Meaning
1	וַיֵּרָא	vayyar	vai-YAR	and He saw
2	אֱלֹהִים	Elohim	eh-lo-HEEM	God
3	אֶת־הָאוֹר	et-ha'or	et ha-OR	the light [direct object]
4	כִּי־טוֹב	ki-tov	kee TOVE	that it was good
5	וַיַּבְדֵּל	vayyavdel	vai-yav-DEL	and He divided / separated
6	אֱלֹהִים	Elohim	eh-lo-HEEM	God
7	בֵּין	bein	BANE	between
8	הָאוֹר	ha'or	ha-OR	the light
9	וּבֵין	uvein	oo-VANE	and between
10	הַחֹשֶׁךְ	ha-choshekh	ha-KHO-shekh	the darkness

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 1

וַיַּרְא

Transliteration	vayyar
Pronunciation	vai-YAR
Meaning	and He saw
From / dictionary form	וַיַּרְא ra'ah - to see

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
רְ	Resh	r	Sheva is very short or silent here.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 2

אלהים

Transliteration	Elohim	
Pronunciation	eh-lo-HEEM	
Meaning	God	
From / dictionary form	אלהים	Elohim - God

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Hatef Segol gives a quick 'eh' sound.
ל	Lamed	l	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 3

אֶת־הָאוֹר

Transliteration	et-ha'or	
Pronunciation	et ha-OR	
Meaning	the light [direct object]	
From / dictionary form	אוֹר	or - light

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
אֶ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
ת	Tav	t	No vowel mark on this letter here.
—	Maqaf	no sound	Maqaf joins the words; it has no sound.
הֶ	He (hay)	h	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
אֶ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
וֹ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 4

כִּי־טוֹב

Transliteration	ki-tov		
Pronunciation	kee TOVE		
Meaning	that it was good		
From / dictionary form	טוֹב	tov	good

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
ךְ	Kaf	k	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound. Dagesh makes Kaf a hard K sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
—	Maqaf	no sound	Maqaf joins the words; it has no sound.
ט	Tet	t	No vowel mark on this letter here.
וֹ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ב	Bet	v	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 5

וַיַּבְדֵּל

Transliteration	vayyavdel
Pronunciation	vai-yav-DEL
Meaning	and He divided / separated
From / dictionary form	בָּדַל badal - divide / separate

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
בְּ	Bet	v	Sheva is very short or silent here.
דְּ	Dalet	d	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
ל	Lamed	l	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 6

אלהים

Transliteration	Elohim		
Pronunciation	eh-lo-HEEM		
Meaning	God		
From / dictionary form	אלהים	Elohim - God	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Hatef Segol gives a quick 'eh' sound.
ל	Lamed	l	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 7

בֵּין

Transliteration	bein
Pronunciation	BANE
Meaning	between
From / dictionary form	בֵּין bein - between

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
בֿ	Bet	b	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound. Dagesh makes Bet sound B, not V.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ן	Final Nun	n	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 8

הָאֹר

Transliteration	ha'or	
Pronunciation	ha-OR	
Meaning	the light	
From / dictionary form	אֹר	or - light

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
הָ	He (hay)	h	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
וֹ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 9

וּבֵין

Transliteration	uvein
Pronunciation	oo-VANE
Meaning	and between
From / dictionary form	וּבֵין וּ u + bein

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	oo	Shuruk: Vav + dot makes the 'oo' sound.
בִּ	Bet	v	Tsere gives an 'ay/eh' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ן	Final Nun	n	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Word / Phrase 10

הַחֹשֶׁךְ

Transliteration ha-choshekh

Pronunciation ha-KHO-shekh

Meaning the darkness

From / dictionary form חֹשֶׁךְ choshekh - darkness

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
הַ	He (hay)	h	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
חֿ	Chet	kh	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
שֵׁ	Shin / Sin	sh	Segol gives the 'eh' sound. Right-hand Shin dot makes SH.
ךְ	Final Kaf	kh	Sheva is very short or silent here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:4 - Put It All Together

Start at the RIGHT edge and move LEFT. Say the letter names and notice the vowel marks as you write.

וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָאֹר כִּי־טוֹב וַיַּבְדֵּל אֱלֹהִים בֵּין הָאֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ:

Pronunciation: vai-YAR eh-lo-HEEM et ha-OR kee TOVE vai-yav-DEL eh-lo-HEEM bane ha-OR oo-VANE ha-KHO-shekh.

Meaning: And God saw the light, that it was good; and God divided the light from the darkness.

Copy the complete verse: